

Change Blindness Starter Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 10-15 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	10-15 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	change-blindness-starter

Big idea: Attention selects reality before we report it.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students experience that attention does not record every visible detail.

Student Prompt

Inspect Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Change Blindness Starter Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A slide pair where a key word in a TOK claim changes from 'proves' to 'suggests'. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Change Blindness Starter Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A live scene where a book, chair, or water bottle is moved while students look away. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Attention selects reality before we report it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Change Blindness Starter Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how attention selects reality before we report it.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: Two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Two classroom photos where the clock time, board heading, and one desk object change.
- A slide pair where a key word in a TOK claim changes from 'proves' to 'suggests'.
- A live scene where a book, chair, or water bottle is moved while students look away.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/change-blindness/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/change-blindness/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/change-blindness/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Show Image A for 10 seconds.
2. Switch to Image B for 10 seconds, or alternate quickly between the two.
3. Ask students to write down the change privately before discussing.
4. Reveal the change and ask students what they assumed they had noticed.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: If perception is selective, when should observation be trusted?
- What do we mean when we say, "I saw it with my own eyes"?
- Link to eyewitness testimony, scientific observation, journalism and memory.

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...